Dharvi Prajapati

User Experience & Strategic Research Designer

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LinkedIn
Portfolio

EDUCATION

National Institute of Design
2025-2028
M.Des Strategic Design Management
Gandhinagar, Gujarat

National Institute of Fashion Technology
2016-2020
B.Des Textile Design
Hauz Khas, New Delhi

EXPERIENCE

WeHear Innovations
Sep 2026 - Present
Strategic Design Consultant
Ahmedabad, Gujarat

- Conducted design audits and organisational assessments to identify performance gaps, align people, processes, systems, and culture with strategic objectives, and uncover opportunities for design-led improvement.

Window Passions
Jan 2024 - Jun 2025
Project Lead
MG Road, New Delhi

- Led end-to-end soft interior ***projects averaging 51,250 sq. ft., delivering 10+ projects annually for residential (B2C) and commercial (B2B) clients across India.***
- Led client engagements and built long term relationships by translating requirements into actionable design strategies, ***aligning 25+ architects***, vendors, and cross-functional teams for seamless execution, premium service delivery, and repeat business.
- Directed material selection, sampling, and mockup development, aligning design solutions with client budgets and commercial feasibility while maintaining quality standards
- ***Led the brand's exhibition team in India Design 2024 (Mumbai) & India Design 2025 (New Delhi), connecting with 50+ potential clients***
- Oversaw project lifecycle execution including site visits, production coordination with vendors and final installations to meet delivery deadlines

  Clients : Oberoi Group of Hotels, Hiren Patel Architects (HPA), OpenIdeas Architects, Architecture Discipline, Manish Kumat Design Cell, Archana Aggarwal Architect, Project 810 and more

Shades of India
Jan 2023 - Jan 2024
Project Lead
Noida, Uttar Pradesh

- Led client consultations to translate requirements into bespoke design concepts, improving client satisfaction aligned with adherence to luxury design standards, detailing accuracy, and execution quality across all deliverables ***over 15+ tier-1 & tier-2 cities across India.***
- ***Managed 12+ projects valued at ₹15 lakh each***, driving process and product redesign initiatives to ***optimise manufacturing efficiency*** , reduce production costs, and improve cost effectiveness.
- Oversaw the end-to-end process from sampling development and prototyping to technical documentation, vendor coordination, production execution and quality control, ensuring design feasibility and seamless manufacturing.

  Clients : Studio Lotus, K2India, Shabnam Gupta (The Orange Lane), Ayush Kasliwal Studio (AKFD), Stapati Architects, WMA Architects, Demero Das and more

Mo Home
July 2022 - Jan 2023
Textile Designer
Gurugram, Haryana

- Designed and curated bespoke textile wall panels and mixed media wall art for ***premium clients, securing 4 projects worth ₹55 lakh through tailored design solutions and customization.***
- Designed and executed product and experiential displays across retail stores in Gurugram, ***enhancing customer engagement and sales conversion across home décor segments by 12%.***
- Established and strengthened walk-in client engagement, converting inquiries into high value design projects and long term associations, contributing to improved ***footfall-to-conversion ratios by 5%.***

Pala Decor
Sep 2020 - Jun 2022
Textile Designer
Gurugram, Haryana

- Led product development across home soft goods categories, creating trend led, buyer specific ***seasonal collections for 11+ international buyers across European and Australian*** markets to strengthen product market fit and global market readiness.
- Product design using pitloom and powerloom weaving techniques, optimising pricing and production costs while maintaining design quality, craftsmanship, and manufacturing scalability.
- Integrated global trend forecasting with natural grass innovation to develop sustainable, market relevant home décor products and strengthen competitive positioning
- ***Represented the brand at HGH India 2022, strengthening industry visibility and engaging with 60+ potential International buyers***
- Drove costing analysis and price optimization, ensuring margin efficiency without compromising design quality

  Clients : Zara Home, Restoration Hardware, Kirkland, TJ Maxx, Carrefour, DG, IKEA, Anthropologie, Jaipur Living, Weylandts and more

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Offspace (Service Design)

- Designed Offspace, a service offering design students brief moments of personal space. Conducted user research, behavioural analysis, and archetype development to identify unmet needs and define service opportunities.
- Translated insights into ***service concepts, iteratively tested alpha and beta prototypes***, and developed a service blueprint mapping user journeys, operational workflows, and technology integrations to assess feasibility and scalability.

Understanding human behaviour (Hindu Religious Temples)

- Explored the root causes of behavioural deviations within a Hindu temple through ethnographic research and spatial behaviour mapping. Translated stakeholder interactions and behavioural patterns into a ***three-stage framework for behaviour change, using simulation-based testing*** to develop non-coercive interventions that encourage positive behavioural shifts.

Adventure Tourism (Research Design)

- Designed ***a comprehensive research plan for India's adventure tourism ecosystem***, combining secondary research and primary research methodologies to investigate tourist motivations, decision making behaviours, stakeholder dynamics, and gaps across core and ancillary services.
- Developed stakeholder maps, user archetypes, and journey maps, synthesising qualitative and quantitative research to uncover experience barriers and define strategic intervention opportunities for enhancing tourism experiences and regional economic impact.

Civil Hospital x NID

- Conducted a people centred ***service audit at Civil Hospital Ahmedabad*** to identify gaps across the OPD patient journey. Used visual ethnography, ***shadowing, and stakeholder interviews to map patient behaviour***s, service touchpoints, and operational bottlenecks, translating research insights into strategic opportunities for process redesign, improved patient experience, and operational efficiency.

FabIndia x NIFT

- Executed on ground design research with farmer communities in Panipat, Haryana to explore sustainable utilization of post-harvest agricultural waste (stubble). Synthesized user insights to conceptualize ***circular product systems co-created with local communities***. Designed ***inclusive livelihood models***, enabling skill building and income generation for women through decentralized production ecosystems.

Office of Development Commissioner (Handlooms) x NIFT

- Conducted immersive field research with artisan communities in Barmer, Rajasthan, to understand traditional appliqué craft practices, livelihood systems, and opportunities for contemporary market relevance. ***Co-developed innovative product interventions with artisans***, translating craft insights into contemporary designs while preserving traditional techniques, intricate detailing, and cultural identity.

POSITION OF RESPONSIBILITY & AWARDS

Indian Textile Sourcing Fair (ITSF'19)

Visual Merchandising Volunteer

- Collaborated with the visual merchandising team to showcase artisans' products, highlighting new innovations and product lines through effective product display and presentation.

Lakmé Fashion Week '19

Student Volunteer

- Supported backstage operations and event coordination, ensuring smooth preparation and execution of show activities.

Tasar Design Award by Eco Tasar '19

Top 25 Design Award

- Top 25 Design award (Student category) for excellent & innovative design using Tasar yarn.

SKILLS

Design: UX Design, User Flows, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Prototyping, Design Systems, Inclusive & Accessible Design, Critical Thinking, Analytical Reasoning, Human-Centered Design, Product Development
Research: User Research, Contextual Inquiry, Behavioural Design, Service Innovation, Persona Development, User Journey Mapping, Qualitative Research Synthesis, Usability Testing, Qualitative Insight Generation & Data Analysis
Strategy: Design Research, Customer Experience, Design Thinking, Systems Thinking, Service Design, Brand & Design Strategy, Trend Forecasting, Cross-functional Collaboration,UX Audit, Intervention Matrix & Strategy

TOOLS

Adobe Design Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), Figma, Miro, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office Suite, FigJam
Gen AI Tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Google AI Studio)